

Samsung Galaxy M55 5G

Blend of the good and the bad

After the Samsung Galaxy S series and the Galaxy A-series, it is now time for Samsung to refresh the more common Samsung Galaxy M series of smartphones. With the new Samsung Galaxy M35 and Galaxy M55, Samsung aims to make its budget-centric devices more premium. The Samsung Galaxy M55, which is the bigger sibling among the two, comes with quite a few new things, but misses out on stuff at the same time.

But does it make sense as an upgrade to the Samsung Galaxy M54 or has Samsung just launched the Samsung Galaxy M55 for the sake of it? Let's find out.

DESIGN

Like always, I'm going to start with the design. From the face of it, the Samsung Galaxy M55 looks very similar to its predecessor the Samsung Galaxy M54, which didn't come to India. The smartphone has a rather tall orientation with slightly squared corners. I also noticed a slight curve on the back panel, which has this "Light Green" colour in a matte finish. Looks cool.

The plastic frame is also curved around the edges, which is nice since it helps with the grip and in-hand feel. The matte finish also ensures there are no fingerprints or smudges on the back panel. Further, in true Samsung fashion, the cameras protrude out of the back panel only, there is no module on the Samsung Galaxy M55.

Up front, we get even bezels across the four sides, with a slight forehead and a chin, but it doesn't look bad since things are even. The display also

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curves into the frame on the edges, which gives a bit of a premium feel to the Samsung Galaxy M55.

The design is simple and elegant, in my opinion. This is definitely one of the prettiest Samsung Galaxy M-series that I have tested so far so that's good. I'm

someone who'd rather go for the plain black colour instead of the "Light Green" shade that Samsung sent me for review, but well, there's something for everything.

DISPLAY

Coming to display, this is Samsung's strong suit. The smartphone comes with a 6.7-inch Super AMOLED Plus display with a 120Hz refresh rate and an FHD+ resolution. Now, while on paper this looks good, the display is missing out on a few things from its predecessor. Firstly, we don't get Corning Gorilla Glass protection as

compared to the Galaxy M54, which had a Gorilla glass 5 protection. Further, the pixel density on the Samsung Galaxy M55 seems to be lower than the pixel density of the Samsung Galaxy M54 (393 ppi on the M54 vs 385 ppi on the M55), but since the difference is negligible, you will never see the difference.

The display of the Samsung Galaxy M55 5G is sharp and bright. Samsung is claiming a peak brightness of 1,000 nits in High Brightness mode, and let me tell you these claims aren't too far from the real world picture. The Samsung Galaxy M55 5G put out an impressive peak luminance of 841 nits in our Lux Meter test, which is brilliant, since we hardly see such close results from the claimed numbers. Although the claimed numbers are of the brightest 1 percent of the display, this is impressive.

One thing I really didn't like here is that there is no option to change the colour profile of the display. In the display settings, I can't adjust the display's colours according to my taste, something we have seen with pretty much every Samsung smartphone. Although there is the option of turning on "True Tone" on the Galaxy M55, there is no option of switching to a colour profile of my choice.

Overall, this is a pretty decent display. I didn't get the time to test the colour accuracy, but it looks more vibrant than true-to-life. With that, we are getting brilliant sunlight visibility and viewing angles with the Samsung Galaxy M55 5G. It is sharp, it is responsive (thanks to 120Hz refresh rate), and it is bright enough to use in all environments, no matter how bright.

PERFORMANCE

Now, the Samsung Galaxy M55 5G is powered by a Qualcomm Snapdragon 7 Gen 1 chipset paired with up to 12GB of RAM. While I'm glad Samsung didn't pick an Exynos chip for this mid-ranger, the brand went with a two year old Snapdragon 7 Gen 1 chip when there are some competing brands that are offering newer Snapdragon 7 Gen 2